PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

AI for Professionals Programme

The "Train-2, Place-2" Employer Partnership Model

Programme	AI for Professionals Programme
Implementing partners	Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST) Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry (MoTAI)
Target regions	Greater Accra, Ashanti (Kumasi) and Northern Ghana (Tamale)

Executive Summary

The **AI for Professionals Programme** is a high-impact national initiative implemented by **Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST)** in direct partnership with **Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH**, under the Private Sector and Innovation Promotion (PSInno) Programme commissioned by Germany's Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development (BMZ), and Ghana's **Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry (MoTAI)**.

The primary goal of this initiative is to equip at least **120 young Ghanaian professionals and tertiary graduates** with market-validated, practical Artificial Intelligence (AI) skills. Rather than focusing on abstract theory or standalone academic certifications, the programme is structured as an **employer-driven talent pipeline**.

Through our innovative **"Train-2, Place-2" Partnership Model**, private-sector organisations, technology firms, SMEs and public-sector institutions are invited to co-design talent standards, upskill their existing staff at **zero cost**, and gain priority access to job-ready, AI-fluent graduates.

1. The Business Case: Why Your Organisation Needs an AI-Ready Workforce

The rapid evolution of generative AI and digital automation is reshaping business operations across every sector in Ghana. Traditional job roles are being redefined, not replaced but elevated, as workers integrate modern AI tools to maintain operational speed, reduce overheads and drive competitive growth.

> **THE AI ADVANTAGE FOR ENTERPRISES**
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> - **Operational efficiency:** automate routine tasks and shorten turnaround times.
> - **Higher-quality output:** augment software, analytics, design and marketing work.
> - **Market competitiveness:** stay ahead of local and international rivals.
> - **Cost reduction:** fully funded corporate upskilling (GIZ / KNUST).

The Problem in Ghana's Market

Employers consistently report a severe shortage of practical, industry-ready AI skills in the local talent pool. While tertiary graduates bring foundational knowledge, most lack hands-on fluency with production-grade AI tools, critical output validation and end-to-end workflow integration.

The Solution

The AI for Professionals Programme bridges this gap by directly involving industry partners in curriculum co-validation and by providing rigorous, project-based training that matches live employer demand.

2. The "Train-2, Place-2" Partnership Model

The **Train-2, Place-2** framework is designed to deliver immediate, measurable return on investment for participating partner organisations, without imposing financial burdens or training fees.

TRAIN 2
Upskill your staff
Nominate two (2) existing employees for 100% free, high-end, 160-hour practical AI training.

PLACE 2
Hire programme graduates
Commit two (2) placement slots (internship, project contract or direct hire) for programme graduates.

What Participating Partners Receive

1. **Free executive and technical upskilling:** nominate **two (2) of your existing staff** to enrol in our intensive 160-hour (8-week) practical training tracks free of charge, upgrading your internal capability.
2. **First-right access to top graduate talent:** secure **two (2) high-performing, job-ready graduates** through paid internships, project-based contracts or full-time roles, tailored to your firm's specific skill requirements.

3. **Curriculum co-validation:** help review and align syllabus modules so that graduates learn the exact tools, frameworks and workflows your firm relies on.
4. **Real-world SME diagnostics:** submit live internal business challenges to be solved by participants during their hands-on capstone projects, under expert supervision.
5. **Institutional recognition:** receive public co-branding and recognition across KNUST, GIZ and Ministry platforms as a pioneering AI-ready employer.

3. Programme Structure & Learning Tracks

Training is delivered across two strategic hubs: **KNUST Kumasi** (primary hub) and the **University for Development Studies (UDS), Tamale** (satellite hub). Delivery is hybrid, combining synchronous face-to-face labs, LMS e-learning and practical industry diagnostics.

Employers can align their nominated staff and graduate-hiring slots across four specialised 160-hour learning tracks:

1	**AI for Creatives** • Generative AI tools for visual design, video and audio production, and brand assets • Prompt engineering for creative workflows and client-delivery presentations
2	**AI for Data Analytics & Business Intelligence** • Automated data cleaning, predictive modelling and BI dashboarding • Critical evaluation of AI outputs, data ethics and executive reporting
3	**AI-Augmented Software Development** • AI-assisted coding, automated debugging, testing and code documentation • Integration of LLM APIs and modern AI developer tools into software stacks
4	**AI for Digital Marketing & E-Commerce** • AI-driven customer acquisition, personalised ad campaigns and automated copywriting • E-commerce store optimisation and predictive consumer analytics

4. Partner Commitments & Implementation Workflow

To participate, partner organisations enter into a simple, non-binding Partnership Agreement (MOU) outlining mutual expectations. The process has six steps:

STEP 1	Sign the Partnership Commitment / Nomination Form.
STEP 2	Nominate two (2) existing staff members for free training.
STEP 3	Co-validate curriculum components (1–2 hours of engagement).
STEP 4	Nominated employees complete the 8-week training (KNUST / UDS / hybrid).
STEP 5	Host two (2) programme graduates for placement (internship, contract or hire).

STEP 6	Post-placement outcome tracking and support (3 months).

Obligations Summary

- **No financial cost:** participation in the Train-2, Place-2 model involves **zero fees** payable to KNUST or GIZ.
- **Time release:** partner organisations agree to allow nominated staff to complete the 160 hours of training over the 8-week course schedule.
- **Placement provision:** partner organisations agree to offer viable 3-to-6-month engagement slots (paid internship, project work or full-time position) to two programme graduates following training completion.

5. Programme Timeline & Key Milestones

Phase	Milestone / Activity	Target Period
Phase 1	Partner engagement and employer mapping	October 2026
Phase 2	Curriculum co-validation and agreement signing	October – November 2026
Phase 3	Participant selection and enrolment	November 2026
Phase 4	Intensive training delivery (160 hours / 8 weeks)	December 2026 – January 2027
Phase 5	Graduate placement and freelance linkages	January – February 2027
Phase 6	Post-programme tracking and outcome verification	February 2027 onward

6. How to Become a Project Partner

Organisations interested in free staff upskilling and access to our high-calibre AI graduate talent pool can initiate a partnership by completing the brief **Partnership Commitment & Employee Nomination Form** https://forms.gle/4sFtwBiTPXtoHyxd6 or by contacting our team lead directly.

Programme Secretariat & Linkages Contacts

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- **Implementing institution:** Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST), Kumasi, Ghana
- **Partner entities:** GIZ Ghana (PSInno) and Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry (MoTAI)